

Third party evaluation of CSIR- Floriculture Mission

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Quality Council of India (QCI) is an autonomous organisation established in 1997, through joint initiative of the Government of India and the Indian industry, pursuant to resolution of the Indian Cabinet in 1996. It is registered as a Society under the Societies Registration Act, 1860 with the mandate to establish and operate the national accreditation system in India and promote quality in all aspects of life, industry, environment, and governance. It is a self-sustaining independent organisation with complete financial, administrative, and functional autonomy. The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT), Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Government of India is the nodal point in the government for QCI and all matters concerning quality. The Governing Council of the Society is the apex governing organ of QCI and consists of equal representation of government, industry, and other stakeholders. Chairperson, QCI is nominated by the Prime Minister of India.

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Table of Contents

Background of the CSIR- Floriculture Mission	4
1. Background.....	4
2. Context	4
Quality Council of India (QCI).....	5
3. Introduction to QCI	5
4. Mandate & Structure	5
5. Key projects	6
About CSIR- Floriculture Mission	7
6. Background & Context.....	7
Objectives cum Scope of the Study.....	7
Methodological Framework.....	8
7. Research design and approach	8
8. Proposed Activities/Actions and Expected Insights	8
9. Identification of Stakeholders	9
10. Sampling.....	9
11. Operational Framework & Execution Plan.....	10
Project Financials	12
12. Proposed Financials	12
13. Payment Milestone	12
14. Brief Work Plan & Key Deliverables.....	13

List of Figures

Figure 1: QCI Organisational Structure	5
Figure 2: Triangulation Approach	8
Figure 3: Project Timelines	13

List of Tables

Table 1: Proposed Activities/Action and Expected Insights from TPE of CSIR-Floriculture Mission	8
Table 2: Sampling of Cluster as per Agro-Climatic Zones	10
Table 3: Project Financials	12
Table 4: Payment Milestone	12
Table 5: Project Timelines	13

Background of the CSIR- Floriculture Mission

1. Background

- India's floriculture sector is a high-growth area valued at INR 292 billion in 2024, projected to reach INR 744 billion by 2033 at a CAGR of 10.9%, driven by diverse climates and rising demand for cut and loose flowers. Production reached 695,800 tonnes of cut flowers and 2.16 million tonnes of loose flowers in 2023-24, led by states like West Bengal and Tamil Nadu, though India's global export share remains modest at 0.3%. Exports total 19,678 metric tonnes worth US \$86.63 million (INR 718 crore) in 2023-24, primarily roses to the US, UK, and Germany.
- The CSIR Floriculture Mission operates across 21-29 states/UTs, cultivating floriculture on 1,229 hectares via farmer clusters and integrating apiculture over 4,880 hectares, benefiting 5,917-23,460 farmers. It delivers CSIR technologies through 495 training programs in 535 clusters, aligning with goals to boost incomes and entrepreneurship amid challenges like low protected cultivation (20-30%).
- India's floriculture sector contributes over ₹25,000 crore annually to the economy, with exports reaching 2.5 lakh tonnes in recent years, underscoring its role in agricultural diversification.
- Flowers hold cultural significance in festivals, weddings, and rituals, driving domestic demand while high-value exports target markets like Europe and the Middle East.
- Traditional farming faces challenges like low productivity and climate vulnerability, making technology-driven missions essential for sustainable growth.

2. Context

- The CSIR Floriculture Mission spans 29 states and UTs, covering 3,789 hectares and benefiting 23,460 farmers across 535 clusters through CSIR technologies.
- It integrates floriculture with apiculture, supported by 495 training programs, bridging research and field-level entrepreneurship.
- Aligned with national goals like doubling farmer incomes, it emphasizes agro-climatic diversity for scalable, region-specific impacts.

Quality Council of India (QCI)

3. Introduction to QCI

- 3.1 The Quality Council of India (QCI) has been set up as a non-profit autonomous society registered under the Societies Registration Act XXI of 1860 to establish an accreditation structure in the country and to spread quality movement in India by undertaking a National Quality Campaign.
- 3.2 QCI was established as the National body for Accreditation on recommendations of the Expert Mission of the EU after consultations between the Inter-Ministerial Task Force, Committee of Secretaries, and Group of Ministers and finally a Cabinet decision in 1996.
- 3.3 The Council was made an autonomous non-profit organisation through seed funding initially by the Government of India and the Indian Industry represented by the three premier industry associations: Associated Chambers of Commerce and Industry of India (ASSOCHAM), Confederation of Indian Industry (CII) and Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FICCI).
- 3.4 The Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT), Ministry of Commerce and Industry is the nodal point for all matters connected with Quality and QCI. The Council was established to create a mechanism for third-party assessment of products, services, and processes.

4. Mandate & Structure

- 4.1. Quality Council of India (QCI) has been set up as a non-profit autonomous society to establish and operate the national accreditation system in the country and to spread the quality movement in India by undertaking a national quality campaign.
- 4.2. It was formed by a joint initiative of the Government of India and the Indian Industry associations like the Associated Chambers of Commerce and Industry of India (ASSOCHAM), Confederation of Indian Industry (CII) and Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce and Industry (FICCI).
- 4.3. QCI has established Constituent Boards, Divisions, and Cells catering to various aspects of quality. Its Boards are full members of international systems of accreditation and have multilateral mutual recognition arrangements (MRAs/MLAs) that allow for international equivalence and recognition of conformity assessment outcomes.

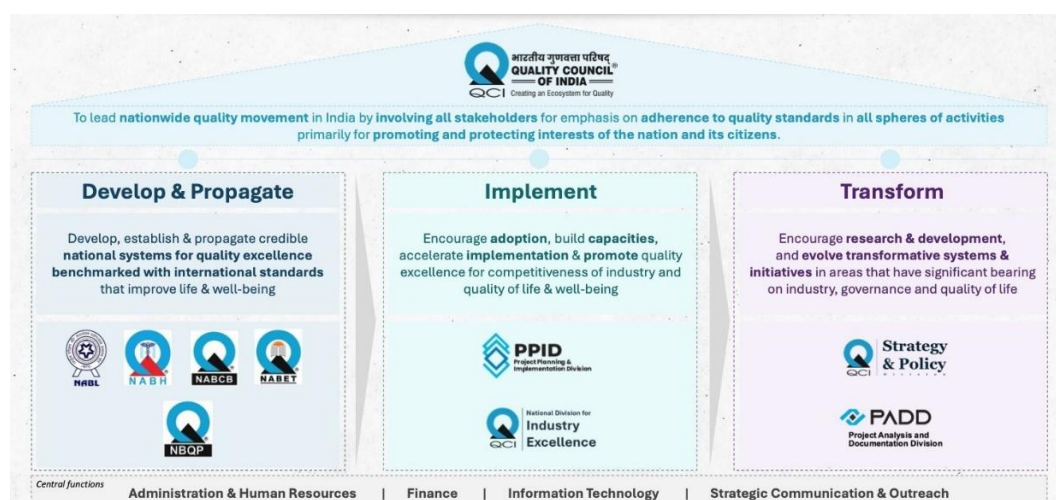


Figure 1: QCI Organisational Structure

4.4. Constituent Boards

- 4.4.1. **National Accreditation Board for Testing & Calibration Laboratories (NABL):** NABL accredits testing, calibration, and medical labs, as well as proficiency testing providers and reference material producers, based on international standards. NABL is a member of ILAC and APAC.
- 4.4.2. **National Accreditation Board for Certification Bodies (NABCB):** NABCB accredits Certification, Inspection, and Validation/Verification Bodies based on international standards and is a full member of IAF, ILAC, and APAC.
- 4.4.3. **National Accreditation Board for Hospitals and Healthcare Providers (NABH):** NABH accredits hospitals and healthcare organisations, with internationally recognized accreditations.
- 4.4.4. **National Accreditation Board for Education & Training (NABET):** NABET accredits education, training, and skill development organisations to national and international standards, enhancing quality and credibility. It operates under the QCI.
- 4.4.5. **National Board for Quality Promotion (NBQP):** NBQP promotes quality and excellence in India by setting standards, providing certifications, and conducting audits to enhance competitiveness and customer satisfaction.
- 4.4.6. **Special Projects Group (Cells and Divisions)**
 - 4.4.6.1. **Project Planning and Implementation Division (PPID)**
 - 4.4.6.2. National Division for Industry Excellence (NDIE)
 - 4.4.6.3. Projects Analysis and Documentation Division (PADD)
 - 4.4.6.4. Strategy & Policy Division (SPD)

5. Key projects

- 5.1. In 25 years, the Quality Council of India has improved quality of life through initiatives in green development, inclusive growth, digital economy, public infrastructure, and technology. It involves stakeholders to uphold quality standards and enhance citizens' well-being.
- 5.2. As the National Accreditation body of the country, it has been ranked 5th in the world in the recent Global Quality Infrastructure Index (GQII) 2021. In the past 10 years, QCI Professionals have engaged with 90+ ministries and departments of the Union and State Governments in executing 400+ projects across multivariate spheres.
- 5.3. List of few projects being awarded to QCI on nomination basis:
 - 5.3.1. Third-Party Evaluation of Scheme 1 & 2 of National Horticulture Board (NHB)
 - 5.3.2. Third-Party Evaluation of National Programme for Dairy Development (NPDD)
 - 5.3.3. Third-Party Evaluation of Livestock Health & Disease Control Programme (LHDCP)
 - 5.3.4. MSME Sustainable (ZED) Certification Scheme for FY 2023-24 (Ongoing)
 - 5.3.5. Third Party Sampling & Analysis of Coal (Ongoing)
 - 5.3.6. GeM vendor assessment
 - 5.3.7. Quality Intervention to create a Quality Ecosystem for Khadi
 - 5.3.8. Transformation of Food Corporation of India – Assessment of FCI Warehouses

and more than 100 further projects are being awarded to QCI on nomination basis. Work Order will be provided as per requirement.

About CSIR- Floriculture Mission

6. Background & Context

6.1. Overview of CSIR Floriculture Mission

The CSIR Floriculture Mission is a nationwide initiative implemented across 29 States and Union Territories, aimed at enhancing farmer incomes and promoting entrepreneurship through the deployment of CSIR-developed floriculture and apiculture technologies. The Mission has facilitated floriculture interventions over approximately 3,789 hectares, directly benefiting 23,460 farmer families across 535 clusters, and has been supported by 495 structured training programmes. The initiative represents a significant research-to-field effort, integrating scientific innovation with livelihood development.

6.2. Rationale for Socio-Economic Impact Assessment

Given the scale, diversity, and duration of implementation, a systematic socio-economic impact assessment is essential to evaluate the outcomes and effectiveness of the Mission. The assessment will provide evidence-based insights into income enhancement, employment generation, technology adoption, and sustainability outcomes attributable to CSIR interventions. The findings will support strategic learning, accountability, and future programme design.

6.3. Importance of Agro-Climatic Diversity and Representative Sampling

Floriculture outcomes are inherently influenced by agro-climatic conditions, crop suitability, market access, and institutional support. Assessing representative clusters across distinct agro-climatic zones is therefore critical to capture regional variations in impact, identify best practices, and derive scalable lessons applicable at the national level.

Objectives cum Scope of the Study

To assess the socio-economic impact of the CSIR Floriculture Mission through a structured evaluation of selected representative clusters across diverse agro-climatic zones via-

- To assess changes in farmer income, cost structures, and economic resilience attributable to floriculture interventions.
- To evaluate employment generation, livelihood diversification, and gender-related outcomes.
- To examine adoption levels of CSIR floriculture and apiculture technologies and associated productivity changes.
- To assess the effectiveness of training and capacity-building initiatives.
- To analyse entrepreneurship development, value chain integration, and market linkages.
- To document region-specific outcomes, constraints, and sustainability prospects.

Methodological Framework

7. Research design and approach

- 7.1. To conduct a robust evaluation of the CSIR Floriculture Mission, QCI proposes a comprehensive methodological framework rooted in a mixed-methods research design. This approach leverages both quantitative and qualitative data to assess the mission's implementation, socio-economic outcomes, and stakeholder experiences across diverse agro-climatic zones. The framework ensures evidence-based insights, regional representativeness, and actionable recommendations for scaling impact.
- 7.2. The evaluation will follow a triangulation-based model, incorporating:
- 7.2.1. Research (Primary & Secondary)
 - 7.2.1.1. Primary research (field surveys, beneficiary interviews, KIIs, FGDs)
 - 7.2.1.2. Secondary research (policy documents, scheme guidelines, internal reports)
 - 7.2.2. Expert/stakeholder consultations (including SIAs & milk unions)
 - 7.2.3. Financial Assessment (assessment of funds released by GoI under Floriculture Mission and its utilization as per Scheme guidelines/ Operational Guidelines)
- 7.3. Triangulation Approach will offer a comprehensive analysis of Floriculture Mission, by integrating primary research, secondary research, and expert/stakeholder consultations.

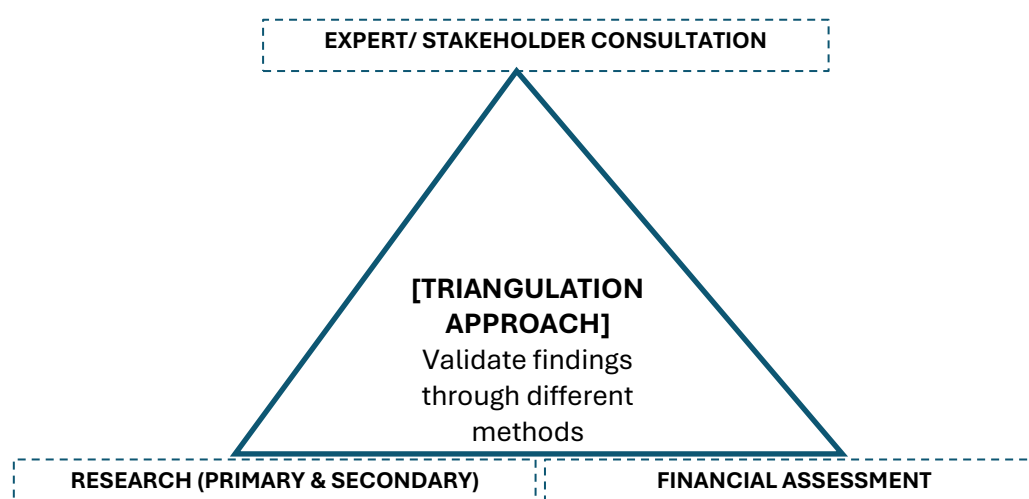


Figure 2: Triangulation Approach

- 7.4. This blended approach ensures a multi-perspective understanding of the programme, helping validate findings, highlight good practices, and identify areas for policy strengthening.

8. Proposed Activities/Actions and Expected Insights

Table 1: Proposed Activities/Action and Expected Insights from TPE of CSIR-Floriculture Mission

Sr. No.	Research Method	Activities/Actions	Expected Insights
1	Research (Primary & Secondary)	- Review mission documents, cluster reports, training records. - Design structured tools (questionnaires, FGD guides). - Conduct surveys, KIIs, FGDs across 82 sampled clusters.	- Implementation trends across agro-climatic zones. - Ground-level adoption and productivity data. - Beneficiary feedback on training and technologies.

Sr. No.	Research Method	Activities/Actions	Expected Insights
2	Output-Outcome cum Gap Analysis	- Develop framework matrix aligned with mission objectives. - Map outputs (e.g., hectares covered) to outcomes (e.g., income rise, employment).	- Alignment of outputs to socio-economic impacts. - Gaps in technology uptake or value chain linkages. - Scalability potential for non-sampled clusters.
3	Financial Assessment	- Analyze adoption metrics from surveys and records. - Evaluate training effectiveness via pre/post knowledge metrics. - Assess apiculture integration outcomes.	- Adoption rates of CSIR varieties/technologies. - Skill enhancement levels. Yield improvements and risk reduction evidence.
4	Stakeholder & Expert Consultation	- Consult CSIR labs, cold stores, cluster coordinators, lead farmers. - Capture qualitative insights on constraints and innovations.	- Systemic challenges (e.g., market access). - Best practices for entrepreneurship. - Recommendations for mission expansion

9. Identification of Stakeholders

To ensure a comprehensive and grounded evaluation of the CSIR Floriculture Mission, QCI has identified the following key stakeholders for structured interactions and consultations:

- Cluster Coordinators/Lead Farmers – Grassroots-level facilitators managing adoption, training, and entrepreneurship in 535 clusters.
- Beneficiary Farmers – Direct recipients (23,460 families across 3,789 hectares) experiencing income, productivity, and livelihood impacts.

These stakeholders will be engaged through in-depth interviews, focus group discussions (FGDs), Key Informant Interviews (KIIs), and field-level case studies to gather diverse insights across technological, economic, and sustainability dimensions of the mission.

10. Sampling

10.1. Geographic Coverage

The CSIR Floriculture Mission is a nationwide initiative implemented across 29 States and Union Territories. The Mission has facilitated floriculture interventions over approximately 3,789 hectares, directly benefiting 23,460 farmer families across 535 clusters, and has been supported by 495 structured training programmes.

QCI proposes to draw sample on basis of clusters and diverse agro-climatic conditions. Considering 535 clusters as the population for the study at confidence level of 90% with margin of error at $\pm 10\%$, the required sample size will be the evaluation of 82 clusters. These clusters will be randomly distributed into different agro-climatic zones as follows:

Table 2: Sampling of Cluster as per Agro-Climatic Zones

S. No.	Agro-climatic Zone	States	Total Cluster	Sampled Cluster	Total Number of Farmer (avg. 5 Farmer per cluster)
1	Eastern-Himalayan	Assam	52	14	70
2	Western-Himalayan	Himachal Pradesh	9	3	15
3	Western-Himalayan	Jammu & Kashmir	106	27	135
4	Eastern /Western Plateau and hills, West coast plains & hills	Maharashtra	36	10	50
5	Eastern Plateau and hills & East coast plains and hills	Odisha	17	5	25
6	Southern Plateau and hills & East coast plains and hills	Tamil Nadu	33	9	45
7	Middle Gangetic Plains & Central Plateau & hills	Uttar Pradesh	53	14	70
Total			306	82	410

10.2. Stakeholder Coverage

- Beneficiary farmers
- Cluster-level coordinators / lead farmers
- Implementing CSIR laboratories / partner institutions
- Trainers and technical experts associated with the Mission

10.3. Data Sources

- **Primary data:** Farmer surveys, Focus Group Discussions (FGDs), Key Informant Interviews (KIIs), and case studies
- **Secondary data:** Mission documents, training records, progress reports, and relevant CSIR publications

11. Operational Framework & Execution Plan

To ensure timely, efficient, and high-quality execution of the CSIR Floriculture Mission impact assessment, QCI proposes a structured operational framework comprising the following key stages:

- **Preliminary Analysis and Development of Evaluation Framework:** A preliminary exploratory review will be conducted through consultations with cluster coordinators and a scan of mission documents. Based on this, an Evaluation Framework will be developed, outlining key indicators for income enhancement, technology adoption,

employment generation, and sustainability aligned with mission objectives across agro-climatic zones.

- **Preparation and Optimization of IT Platform:** QCI will deploy advanced technology platforms for digital data collection via mobile/tablet-based CAPI systems, enabling real-time monitoring across 82 sampled clusters. Approved tools (questionnaires, FGD guides) will include flagging, geo-tagging, time-stamping of crop/field images, short video-recording of practices, and real-time data integrity checks to capture accurate field-level evidence.
- **Pilot Study:** A pilot study will be conducted in 2-3 representative clusters to test questionnaire effectiveness, digital tools, and FGD protocols. Learnings will be shared with CSIR for inputs, addressing challenges like agro-climatic variations or technology-specific queries to ensure seamless nationwide rollout.
- **Training and Deployment of Assessors:** Enumerators and supervisors (20-25 teams) will receive training on mission technologies, survey tools, digital platforms, ethical guidelines, and agro-climatic nuances. Deployment will be staggered across 7 zones (Assam, Himachal Pradesh, J&K, Maharashtra, Odisha, Tamil Nadu, UP) for coordinated coverage of 410 farmers in 82 clusters.
- **Primary Survey, Stakeholder Interviews and Focus Group Discussions (FGDs):** Field surveys will target 410 beneficiary farmers (5 per cluster), with KIIs for CSIR cluster coordinators/heads (82). FGDs (2-3 per zone, 8-12 participants each) will capture collective insights on adoption challenges, market linkages, training effectiveness, and entrepreneurship outcomes.
- **Data Quality Assurance:** A central QCI team will monitor interviews in real-time, with backend quality checks, cross-verification against secondary records, and field visits by senior professionals to 20% of clusters. Multi-level validation will eliminate errors and ensure data authenticity across diverse regions.
- **Data Analysis and Interpretation:** Primary data will be collated with secondary records, analyzed using statistical tools (e.g., adoption rates, income differentials) and thematic coding for qualitative insights, yielding evidence on mission impacts per objectives like yield improvements and scalability.
- **Final Reporting:** Findings will be synthesized into a national report with state-wise summaries, best practices, case studies (10-15), and policy recommendations. A presentation to CSIR will precede submission of the full report, cleaned datasets, annexures, and executive summary.

Project Financials

12. Proposed Financials

Table 3: Project Financials

S.No.	Particulars	Amount
1	QCI's Professionals Fee	₹ 4,80,000
2	Assessment Cost*	₹ 21,05,600
3	Technology Cost	₹ 60,000
4	Reports & Stationaries	₹ 60,000
5	Misc. Office Expenses	₹ 50,000
6	Sub-total	₹ 27,55,600
7	QCI Admin Cost (@12% of Sub-total)	₹ 3,30,672
8	Project Cost	₹ 30,86,272
9	GST (@18%)	₹ 5,55,529
10	Total Project Cost	₹ 36,41,801

*Subjected to proposed number states & clusters cited in Table 2

13. Payment Milestone

Table 4: Payment Milestone

Payment Milestone	
Mobilisation Advance (50%)	₹15,43,136.00
Acceptance of Final Report (50%)	₹15,43,136.00
Project Cost (exclusive of GST)	₹ 30,86,272.00

14. Brief Work Plan & Key Deliverables

QCI proposes 4 months implementation plan from the date of the award of work for the successful execution of activities including key activities like conceptualization and development of evaluation framework including schedules/questionnaires, deployment/mobilization plan of resources, pilot, improvisation based on pilot experiences, field survey, data analysis and reporting after the contract is awarded. Mentioned below is the timeline breakup.

Table 5: Project Timelines

Key Activity	Activity Start (Months)	Activity End (Months)	Duration (Months)	Key Deliverable
Framework development & Submission of Inception Report	0	0.5	0.5	Inception Report
Primary Survey cum Assessment	0.5	3.5	3	
Preparation and submission of Draft Evaluation Report	3	3.75	0.75	Draft Report
Submission of Final Report	3.75	4	0.25	Final Report
Total			4 Months	

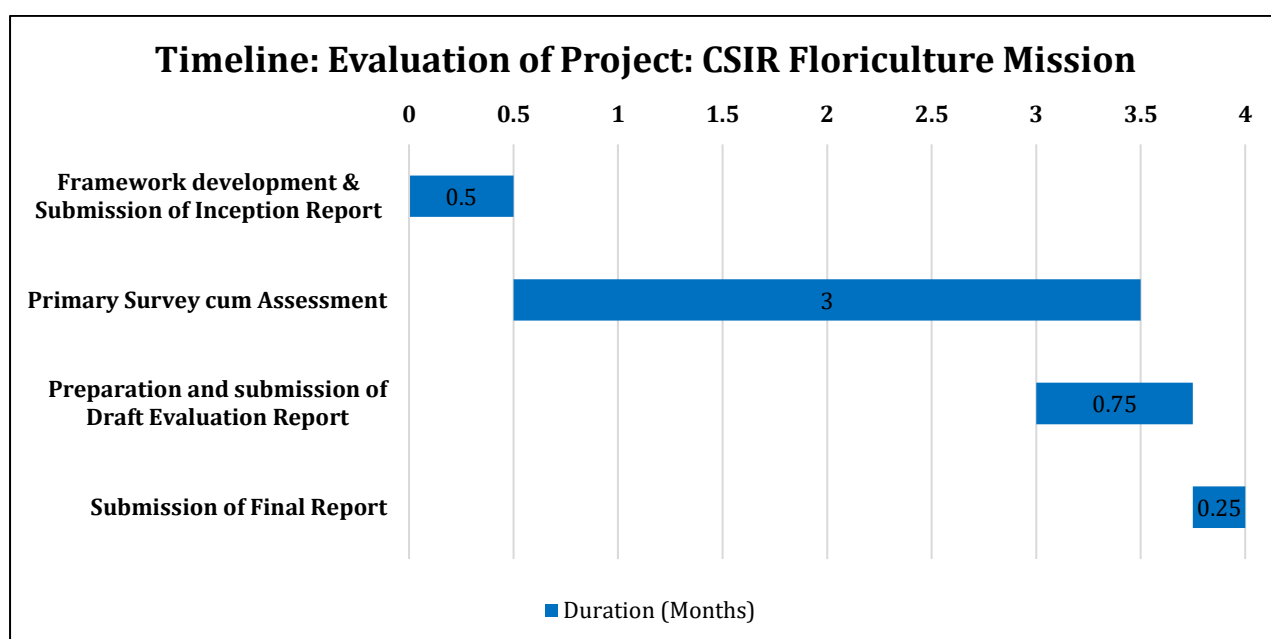


Figure 3: Project Timelines